

Explore gVim as an IDE

gVim is a text editor that meets everyone's needs. It is a modified version of the Vi Editor that is shipped with UNIX. This article was inspired by the impact that gVim made upon the author after he had used it for a few weeks. It simplifies the task of installing plug-ins in gVim to give it an IDE functionality.

In a previous article, we looked at how to install gVim along with Pathogen and Git. Let us begin today's task with a few more installations.

- Vundle - To manage the plug-ins through Vim.
- Lightline - To make a more informative and better looking status bar.
- NERDTree - For a tree-like view of your files.
- Syntastic - A syntax-checking plug-in
- NeoComplCache - For auto completion.
- PerlOmni - The Perl Omnicompletion plug-in that we will use in tandem with the NeoComplCache plug-in.

Note: This article is for gVim version 7.4 on Windows 7. What's shown here might or might not work through console Vim. Most of the settings given below are taken from the respective plug-in documentation and modified as per my needs. You might need to tweak them according to your preferences. The `_vimrc` options and other settings given below are exactly what I have been using for the past few days, so they should work. But in case they do not, please go through the settings documentation or search the Net. I had to fiddle around with the Vundle settings to make it point to the correct folder, but everything else in the documentation should work. If you know a better way of installing the plug-ins or configuring the settings, please do let me know. Like I said in the earlier article, I am no Vim expert.

Vundle: This plug-in is written by 'Gmarik'. It allows the installation of plug-ins from within gVim itself. Vundle

is meant to be used on a Linux or a UNIX system. We will have to make a few changes so that it works fine on Windows. Let's first install Vundle, then make a few changes to the `_vimrc` and `vundle.vim` file, and take it ahead from there. Basically, rather than going to the command prompt and running the `git clone` command, we will use the `:BundleInstall` command at the gVim command prompt to install the plug-ins.



Note: Ensure that you are in the bundle directory while running this command.

To install Vundle, run the following command:

```
git clone https://github.com/gmarik/vundle.git vundle
```

Here's what it looks like on my laptop:

```
C:\Users\Admin\vim\vimfiles\bundle>git clone https://github.com/gmarik/vundle.git vundle
```

```
Cloning into 'vundle'...
remote: Counting objects: 2484, done.
remote: Compressing objects: 100% (1610/1610), done.
remote: Total 2484 (delta 844), reused 2402 (delta 779)
Receiving objects: 100% (2484/2484), 301.02 KiB | 124.00 KiB/s, done.
Resolving deltas: 100% (844/844), done.
```